

Right Modern seafood restaurants hug the water's edge on Volosko's picturesque harbor

Below Bread or polenta plus a glass of crisp *Vrbnička Žlahtina* are the perfect accompaniments to Kvarner scampi



le mandraic

Three Days on the Kvarner Gulf

The oldest resort on the Gulf, genteel Opatija offers plenty in the way of accommodations, culinary culture, and café life. Islands such as Cres and Lošinj, with their stone-built fishing villages and maquis-covered hills, offer more in the way of offbeat relaxed atmosphere.

DAY ONE Stroll **Opatija's** palm-fringed seaside path, the **Lungomare**, which winds its way around a series of rocky bays and gravel beaches. Strike out to the former fishing village of **Volosko**, and southward toward **Lovran**, a town filled with picturesque Art Nouveau villas.

DAY TWO Explore **Rijeka**, the Gulf's one real metropolis, enjoying an espresso at one of the cafés lining the central **Korzo**, or browsing the stands at the bustling market. Take a trip to the hilltop suburb of **Trsat**, site of a ridge-top fortress, for spectacular maritime views.

DAY THREE Take the ferry to the conjoined islands of **Cres** and **Lošinj** (often called "the island of flowers"), where ridges of sheep pasture or Mediterranean maquis loom above sleepy fishing ports.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

International flights arrive at **Zagreb Airport**, a 112-mile (180-km) drive to the Kvarner's main city, Rijeka. **Buses** run from Zagreb's bus station to all of the Gulf's main settlements.

WHERE TO STAY

Pjagal (inexpensive) is a restful family-run B&B in Veli Lošinj. www.pjagal.eu

Palace-Bellevue (moderate) is a *belle-époque* hotel with fine high-ceilinged rooms in the center of Opatija. www.liburnia.hr

Draga di Lovrana (moderate) offers creature comforts and superb views in a hillside mansion high above Opatija and Lovran.

www.dragadilovrana.hr

TOURIST INFORMATION

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